

Co-occurring Experiences and Protective Factors in Adolescent Suicidality (QN22, QN23, QN24, QN25, QN86)

Name: Albert

Variable Name	Variable Question
QN22	During the past 12 months, how many times did someone you were dating or going out with physically hurt you on purpose?
QN23	During your life, how often have you felt that you were treated badly or unfairly in school because of your race or ethnicity?
QN24	During the past 12 months, have you ever been bullied on school property?
QN25	During the past 12 months, have you ever been electronically bullied?
QN86	During the past 30 days, where did you usually sleep?

QN22

Variable Name	Variable Question
QN22	During the past 12 months, how many times did someone you were dating or going out with physically hurt you on purpose?

Why is the QN22 variable relevant to our research?

This variable measures whether a student was physically hurt on purpose by a dating partner in the past 12 months, it captures physical “teen dating violence” (TDV) victimisation, and this variable is classed as an adverse experience. Physical TDV has been consistently linked to elevated suicidal thoughts and behaviours in nationally representative YRBS samples.

A 2021 study by Baiden, Mengo and Small using 2015 national YRBS data, found students with a history of physical TDV were 1.92x more likely to report suicidal ideation, 1.67x more likely to have made a suicide plan, and 2.42x more likely to have attempted suicide than peers without this history. Longitudinal work by Espelage and colleagues (2013) similarly found physical dating violence victimisation predicted later suicidal ideation across grades 9–12, independent of sex and grade.

Dating violence is thought to contribute to suicide risk through feelings of hopelessness, depression, and loss of relational safety, making it a plausible and well-evidenced adverse predictor for co-occurrence analysis.

References

- Ackard, D.M., Neumark-Sztainer, D., 2002. Date violence and date rape among adolescents: associations with disordered eating behaviors and psychological health. *Child Abuse & Neglect* 26, 455–473. [https://doi.org/10.1016/s0145-2134\(02\)00322-8](https://doi.org/10.1016/s0145-2134(02)00322-8)
- Baiden, P., Mengo, C., Small, E., 2019. History of Physical Teen Dating Violence and Its Association With Suicidal Behaviors Among Adolescent High School Students: Results From the 2015 Youth Risk Behavior Survey. *Journal of Interpersonal Violence* 36, NP9526–NP9547. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0886260519860087>
- Nahapetyan, L., Orpinas, P., Song, X., Holland, K., 2013. Longitudinal Association of Suicidal Ideation and Physical Dating Violence among High School Students. *Journal of Youth and Adolescence* 43, 629–640. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10964-013-0006-6>

QN23

Variable Name	Variable Question
QN23	During your life, how often have you felt that you were treated badly or unfairly in school because of your race or ethnicity?

Why is the QN23 variable relevant to our research?

This variable measures lifetime perceived racial or ethnic discrimination experienced specifically in the school setting.

It is classed as an adverse experience. Perceived racial discrimination (PRD) is recognised as a major social determinant of health for adolescents.

A 2022 report by Baiden and colleagues analysed the CDC's 2021 Adolescent Behaviors and Experiences Survey and found PRD in school was significantly associated with suicidal ideation, planning, and attempts among racial and ethnic minority adolescents. Using the 2023 YRBS data found persistent sadness/hopelessness and vaping partially mediated the pathway from PRD to suicidal thoughts and behaviours, suggesting PRD operates both directly and through downstream mental-health and coping pathways.

Including this variable is important as it allows the analysis to examine an adversity dimension that is distinct from interpersonal violence or bullying, as this is rooted in identity-based discrimination and investigating this variable is linked to equity awareness, which we can talk about).

References

Baiden, P., LaBrenz, C.A., Onyeaka, H.K., Muoghalu, C., Nicholas, J.K., Spoor, S.P., Bock, E., Taliaferro, L.A., 2022. Perceived racial discrimination and suicidal behaviors among racial and ethnic minority adolescents in the United States: Findings from the 2021 adolescent behaviors and experiences survey. *Psychiatry Research* 317, 114877. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.psychres.2022.114877>

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QN24

Variable Name	Variable Question
QN24	During the past 12 months, have you ever been bullied on school property?

Why is the QN24 variable relevant to our research?

This variable measures in-person peer bullying victimisation in the past 12 months and is classed as an adverse experience. School bullying is one of the most extensively documented correlates of adolescent suicidality in the YRBS literature.

A 2014 report Messias, Kindrick and Castro analysed the 2011 national YRBS, found bullying victimisation (school, electronic, or both) was strongly associated with sadness and suicidality, with the highest odds observed for students experiencing both forms.

A meta-analysis by Holt and colleagues (2015) similarly concluded bullying involvement — as victim, perpetrator, or both — was consistently associated with suicidal ideation and attempts across dozens of studies.

School bullying is included alongside electronic bullying (QN25) to allow the analysis to compare whether in-person and online victimisation show similar or differing associations with the four suicide outcomes, and whether experiencing both forms compounds the association, consistent with prior findings.

References

Holt, M.K., Vivolo-Kantor, A.M., Polanin, J.R., Holland, K.M., DeGue, S., Matjasko, J.L., Wolfe, M., Reid, G., 2015. Bullying and Suicidal Ideation and Behaviors: A Meta-Analysis. *Pediatrics* 135, e496–e509. <https://doi.org/10.1542/peds.2014-1864>

Messias, E., Kindrick, K., Castro, J., 2014. School bullying, cyberbullying, or both: Correlates of teen suicidality in the 2011 CDC youth risk behavior survey. *Comprehensive Psychiatry* 55, 1063–1068. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.comppsy.2014.02.005>

QN25

Variable Name	Variable Question
QN25	During the past 12 months, have you ever been electronically bullied?

Why is the QN25 variable relevant to our research?

This variable measures *cyberbullying* victimisation in the past 12 months and is classed as an adverse experience. Cyberbullying has been shown to carry mental-health risks distinct from, and in some studies more potent than, in-person bullying. This is partly attributed to the anonymity and potential of the around-the-clock nature of online harassment.

Messias, Kindrick and Castro found students who experienced both school and electronic bullying had markedly higher odds of suicidality than those experiencing either form alone. Also, Bauman, Toomey and Walker (2013) likewise found cyberbullying victimisation independently predicted suicide-related outcomes among US high school students after accounting for traditional bullying and depressive symptoms.

Given the possible additive or compounding effect of experiencing both traditional and electronic bullying, this variable was selected as a complement to QN24 so in the presentation can address overlap between the two forms rather than treating them as interchangeable.

References

Bauman, S., Toomey, R.B., Walker, J.L., 2013. Associations among bullying, cyberbullying, and suicide in high school students. *Journal of Adolescence* 36, 341–350.

<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.adolescence.2012.12.001>

Kowalski, R.M., Giumetti, G.W., Schroeder, A.N., Lattanner, M.R., 2014. Bullying in the digital age: A critical review and meta-analysis of cyberbullying research among youth. *Psychological Bulletin* 140, 1073–1137. <https://doi.org/10.1037/a0035618>

QN86

Variable Name	Variable Question
QN86	During the past 30 days, where did you usually sleep?

Why is the Q86 variable relevant to our research?

This variable measures whether a student experienced unstable housing in the past 30 days. This includes: couch-surfing, or staying in a shelter. It is classed as an adverse experience and, unlike most other variables in my group, it reflects a structural circumstance rather than an interpersonal event.

Housing instability was added to the national YRBS for the first time in 2021, and CDC's own analysis (McKinnon et al., 2023) found that although only 2.7% of US high school students experienced unstable housing, these students reported substantially higher rates of suicidal ideation and attempts than stably housed peers, alongside elevated violence exposure and substance use.

State/local YRBS data compiled by SchoolHouse Connection similarly found unstably housed students were roughly twice as likely to have seriously considered suicide or made a plan, and over three times as likely to have attempted suicide, compared with stably housed peers.

This variable was specifically named in the Team 4 handbook as a housing-instability factor to examine, and its inclusion allows the group's adversity profile to extend beyond interpersonal/violence-based adversity into a socioeconomic and circumstantial dimension, consistent with the project's equity-awareness goal of linking inequality to circumstance and access rather than to individual or group deficit.

Reference

McKinnon, I.I., Krause, K.H., Robin, L., King, A., Leon-Nguyen, M., Zavala, E., Suarez, N.A., Lim, C., Smith-Grant, J., Underwood, J.M., 2023. Experiences of Unstable Housing Among High School Students — Youth Risk Behavior Survey, United States, 2021. MMWR Supplements 72, 29–36. <https://doi.org/10.15585/mmwr.su7201a4>